from Delhi to Daulatabad in the Deccan region of present-day Maharashtra in the 14th century.[62] When rulers were not building cities or moving away from them, they faced the threat of attacks, decline and desertion. Such a fate befell the magnificent urban settlement of the Vijayanagar Empire in the Deccan, which flourished in the 15th and early 16th centuries but was deserted soon after its defeat at the hands of the Deccan Sultanate in the Battle of Talikota in 1565 CE. The remnants of the empire can be seen today at Hampi.

The other noteworthy aspect of medieval migration was that of skilled labour. The Mughal court attracted nobles and scholars from beyond the Indus. It also brought in Persian painters, calligraphers and artisans by paying higher salaries, dubbed by some historians as a potential brain drain into India.[63] Skilled labour was often tied with specific communities and regions. The Dak Meoras, comprising the Meos of Mewat in north India, served as trusted post carriers for the Mughal Empire, while the Aiyangar Pattamars operated separately as couriers around the southern tips of the subcontinent.[64] Julaha weavers, Kagozia papermakers, Kashmiri shawl-makers and Persian carpet-makers were some of the many groups noted for migration.[65] In the 17th century, some Persian carpet-makers settled in Godavari district of Andhra Pradesh in south India and when, in the 18th century, Iranian king Nadir Shah sacked Delhi, Indian carpenters and shipwrights were taken back to Iran reportedly to build 1100 boats in 1740 on the banks of the Oxus. Stone-cutters, masons, goldsmiths and other craftsmen were also taken to build a city in Iran on the lines of the Indian city he had just plundered. If not war, artisans were also found fleeing from famines or unjust pricing regimes. In 1636, weavers left Baroda for Surat to protest against pre-dictated prices but were persuaded to return by the local governor in scenes reminiscent of 21st century negotiations over the Goods and Services Tax (GST) regime in India.

Weaver migrations in medieval south India were one of those migrations that left a deep imprint in inscriptions and folk traditions and have been brought to light by historian Vijaya Ramaswamy in painstaking detail. These migrations were either on invitation by local rulers or decisions made